

Standard Operating Procedure

Universal Medication Labelling

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.6.d (CORE, Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» labels every dispensed medication — inpatient and outpatient, including reconstituted drugs, cut strips, and bulk containers — so a medication is never administered from an unlabelled source.

2. Scope

Applies to every medication dispensed anywhere in the hospital, for every patient type.

3. Responsibility

Dispensing Pharmacist / Nurse: labels every dispensed unit before it leaves their hands.

4. Procedure

1. Label every dispensed medication for both inpatients and outpatients — labelling scope is universal, not outpatient-only.
2. Label reconstituted drugs — including chemotherapy medications — with drug name, strength, and preparation/expiry time immediately after reconstitution, before leaving the preparation area.
3. Label cut strips and bulk containers with drug name, strength, and expiry date, in addition to dosage instructions — a cut strip is never dispensed without its own label.
4. Never rely on the original manufacturer packaging alone once a strip is cut or a bulk container is subdivided.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not dispense or administer any medication — including a reconstituted drug, a cut strip, or a bulk-container portion — without a complete label attached to that specific unit.

Any staff member who finds an unlabelled dispensed medication stops its use immediately and returns it for correct labelling — this is never a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Record 4 of the MOM.6 Required Records pack: Universal Labelling Audit.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_MOM_6_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — MOM.6 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any unlabelled-medication near miss or error.

9. References

- Institute for Safe Medication Practices (ISMP). (n.d.). List of Confused Drug Names. <https://home.ecri.org/blogs/ismp-resources/list-of-confused-drug-names> — labelling practices in this SOP support the differentiation strategies this resource recommends for confusable medications.